GLOBAL WEEK IN REVIEW

Saturday, 25 July 2026 · GMT+8

Everything that mattered this week. Week ending Friday 24 July 2026 US close. All times GMT+8.

The weekend companion to your Daily Need to Know.

1 · Weekly Market Snapshot

Instrument	Fri Close	Week %	YTD*	Note
S&P 500	7,411.98	-0.6%	~+9%	Flat Fri (+0.05%); AI/oil jitters capped a record-chasing tape.
Nasdaq Composite	24,975.82	-2.0%	~+8%	Week's laggard; semis whipsawed, Tesla & Alphabet led the drag.
Dow Jones Ind.	51,947.25	~flat	~+7%	+0.5% Fri recovery; 3rd straight softish week but most resilient.
US 10Y Yield	4.69%	+~10bps	—	Yields up = bonds down; classic Quad3 inflation impulse.
US 2Y Yield	4.33%	+~6bps	—	Curve holds positive; Fed hike back on the table (Jul 28-29).
Dollar (DXY)	~101.4	+~0.5%	—	Firm on higher-for-longer; Hedgeye TREND bullish.
Gold (spot)	$4,044/oz	~flat	~+21% y/y	Capped by firm yields/USD despite geopolitical bid.
Silver (spot)	$58.54/oz	+~1.5%	~+53% y/y	Industrial+monetary bid; the year's standout metal.
Brent Crude	~$96.78	+~12%	—	Topped $100 (1st since May) then fell ~4% Fri on de-escalation hopes.
WTI Crude	~$92	+~11%	—	Back to bullish TREND; Red Sea/Hormuz risk premium.
Bitcoin	~$65,030	-~2%	—	Risk-off + higher yields pulled crypto lower on the week.
VIX	~18.6	higher	—	Spiked +12.4% Thu to ~18.7 on the oil/tech shock; eased Fri.

**YTD and week moves are approximate where a precise weekly print could not be independently confirmed; levels are Friday 24 July US close. Verify live before acting.*

2 · TL;DR

TL;DR — What defined the week

A **war-and-capex** week. The **2026 Iran war** escalated as Houthi militants struck two Saudi tankers and blockaded Red Sea shipping — **Brent topped $100** for the first time since May (**+12% on the week**) before fading Friday. Simultaneously, **AI-capex angst** returned: Alphabet lifted 2026 capex toward **$205bn** and Tesla missed hard (**-14.5% Thu**), dragging the **Nasdaq -2%**. Oil up + bonds down (**10Y 4.69%**) is textbook **#Quad3** — inflation re-accelerating into a Fed meeting where a **hike is suddenly a ~1-in-3 bet**.

3 · The Big Picture — What the Week Meant

1. Oil went to war.

The **2026 Iran war** re-intensified. Iran-backed Houthis claimed strikes on two Saudi tankers (**Layla** and **Encelia**) in the Red Sea and declared a naval blockade; President Trump said he was "close to deciding" on a **"massive attack"** and vowed to hold Iran responsible for every Houthi hit. **Brent settled above $100** for the first time since May and finished **+12% on the week**, even after a ~4% Friday give-back to ~$96.78 as traders priced some de-escalation.

> **Read:** Own the risk premium, not the headline. **Energy is back to a bullish TREND** (Hedgeye Brent range 87–102). A long-energy / short-duration tilt is the cleanest expression; keep it sized for a violent two-way tape around Hormuz.

2. The capex bubble got questioned.

Alphabet beat on earnings (**EPS $9.11, revenue $119.8bn**) but lifted 2026 capex guidance to **$195–205bn** — and the stock **fell 7.1% on the week**. Hyperscaler AI spend is now a cost story as much as a growth story, and the market is repricing the return on all that silicon.

> **Read:** Leadership is narrowing, not broadening. When the biggest capex spender gets sold on a beat, the **AI trade's risk/reward has flipped**. Fade momentum baskets built for a different regime; demand free-cash-flow, not slideware TAM.

3. The Mag7 cracked from within.

Tesla missed badly (**adj. EPS $0.33 vs $0.53 est.**; revenue **+26% to $28.2bn**) as opex jumped ~47% on AI/robotics and regulatory-credit income collapsed 67%. The stock **plunged ~14.5%** and is now **down ~26% in July**. Per Hedgeye's MOMO Tracker, **GOOGL (-7.1%) + TSLA (-14.5%) alone drove ~30% of the S&P's decline**; AMZN and META flipped to bearish TREND.

> **Read:** The index is "netted out," not calm. **Single-stock vol is near a 10-year high versus the index** — dispersion is running the tape. This is a stock-picker's, not a beta-buyer's, market.

4. Rates said Quad3, loudly.

Oil up, bonds down: the **10Y rose to 4.69%** and the **2Y to 4.33%** as the inflation impulse re-accelerated (energy, grains, copper all higher). That is the **#Quad3** signature — growth slowing while inflation re-accelerates — and it lands right before the **28–29 July FOMC**, where markets now assign a **~1-in-3 chance of a rate HIKE**.

> **Read:** Duration is not your friend here. Hedgeye has **all three UST yields on bullish TREND** (yields higher) and **HYG/LQD bearish**. Favor real assets, energy, and cash-flow value over long bonds and long-duration growth.

5. Rotation into the boring stuff.

Beneath a roughly flat S&P, money moved from growth to defensives and cyclicals-with-pricing-power. **Industrials (XLI) led (+~1.8%)** with Utilities firm, while **Communication Services (-5.2%)** and **Consumer Discretionary (-5.1%)** lagged. Hedgeye keeps **XLV, XLU, XLRE and the Russell 2000 on bullish TREND**; **XLK on bearish TREND**.

> **Read:** This is where the leadership is rotating: **defensives + domestic small-cap value** over mega-cap tech. Position for breadth to keep shifting away from the Nasdaq complex.

6. Discipline over conviction.

Semis were **+82% YTD** in early July, **crashed ~15%** into mid-month, then ripped — punishing anyone anchored to last month's thesis. The week's meta-lesson from Hedgeye: markets reward humility and adaptability, not attachment to yesterday's position.

> **Read:** Trade the Trade and Trend levels, not the narrative. When a signal breaks you sell; when it re-signals you buy it back. **Process beats stories in a high-dispersion, unstable-correlation tape.**

4 · Rates, Currencies & Commodities

Rates & credit

Yields backed up across the curve on the inflation impulse: **10Y 4.69%**, **2Y 4.33%**, 30Y toward the low-5s. Credit softened in sympathy — Hedgeye flags **HYG (79.18–79.81) and LQD (106.1–107.7) both bearish TREND**. Initial jobless claims fell to **187k** (week ended 18 Jul), the lowest since mid-May, giving the Fed no cover to ease into firmer oil.

Currencies

The **dollar firmed (DXY ~101.4)** on higher-for-longer repricing; Hedgeye keeps **USD bullish TREND** and **EUR/USD bearish** (1.137–1.148). **USD/JPY (162–163.5) stays bullish** — a weak yen remains the funding-currency tell. Sterling and the euro were soft as the **ECB held at a 2.25% deposit rate** with eurozone inflation cooling to 2.8%.

Commodities

Crude was the story: **Brent +~12% w/w** (peak >$100, close ~$96.78), **WTI back to bullish TREND (80.93–93.41)**. **Silver ($58.54, +~53% y/y)** and **copper (bullish TREND)** underscore the reflation tape, while **gold ($4,044)** was capped by yields/USD and sits on a **bearish immediate-term TREND (3,953–4,150)**. Nat gas stayed bearish.

5 · Hedgeye Risk Ranges & Regime

Regime: **#Quad3** — growth slowing, inflation re-accelerating. Hedgeye is explicitly **"raising the probability of Quad3"** as Energy, grains and copper rise. The August nowcast has leaned Quad3 all month ("Monthly #Quad3 AUG Dynamics", 20 Jul; "Oil Up, Bonds Down = #Quad3", 22 Jul).

Immediate-term Risk Range™ Signals (from the 24 Jul Early Look)

Instrument	Immediate-term Risk Range	TREND
10Y UST Yield	4.55 – 4.73	Bullish
2Y UST Yield	4.19 – 4.37	Bullish
30Y UST Yield	5.08 – 5.18	Bullish
High Yield (HYG)	79.18 – 79.81	Bearish
Invest. Grade (LQD)	106.1 – 107.7	Bearish
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,355 – 7,537	Bullish
Nasdaq Comp (COMPQ)	24,911 – 25,890	Bearish
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,901 – 2,982	Bullish
Technology (XLK)	171 – 185	Bearish
Health Care (XLV)	157 – 163	Bullish
Utilities (XLU)	44.54 – 46.71	Bullish
Real Estate (XLRE)	44.25 – 45.66	Bullish
VIX	15.67 – 19.94	Bearish
US Dollar (DXY)	100.47 – 101.60	Bullish
EUR/USD	1.137 – 1.148	Bearish
USD/JPY	162.01 – 163.50	Bullish
WTI Crude	80.93 – 93.41	Bullish
Brent Crude	87 – 102	Bullish
Gold (spot)	3,953 – 4,150	Bearish
Copper (spot)	6.15 – 6.56	Bullish
Silver (spot)	55 – 61	Bearish
Shanghai Comp	3,711 – 3,935	Bearish
Nikkei 225	63,106 – 67,582	Bearish
German DAX	24,500 – 25,243	Bearish

Where we sit

The signal set is internally consistent with Quad3: **yields bullish, credit bearish, oil/copper bullish, gold & silver bearish (mean-reversion), USD bullish, Nasdaq & XLK bearish, but SPX, RUT and the defensives (XLV/XLU/XLRE)**

bullish. Translation: this is not a "sell everything" tape — it's a **rotation tape**. The Nasdaq (24,911–25,890, bearish) is the funding source; small-cap value, healthcare, utilities, real estate and energy are where the bullish TRENDs live. **VIX (15.67–19.94) is bearish TREND** — i.e., Hedgeye expects vol to keep working higher off the lows on any fresh oil or capex shock.

6 · Mag7 Scoreboard

Name	Price*	Week %	Mkt Cap*	P/E*	Hedgeye TREND
Nvidia (NVDA)	~$212	**-3.5% Fri**	~$4.7-4.8T	~48x	**Bearish**
Apple (AAPL)	~$315	**+3.4% Fri**	~$4.3-4.9T	~35x	—
Alphabet (GOOGL)	~$185	**-7.1% wk**	~$4.3T	~22x	—
Microsoft (MSFT)	~$495	**lower**	~$3.7T	~36x	**Bearish**
Amazon (AMZN)	~$225	**lower**	~$2.4T	~38x	**Bearish**
Meta (META)	~$605	**lower**	~$1.5T	~26x	**Bearish**
Tesla (TSLA)	~$308	**-14.5% Thu**	~$1.0T	~120x	**Bearish**

**Prices, market caps and P/Es are approximate end-of-week reference points; several mega-cap caps could not be pinned to a single confirmed print this week (Apple and Nvidia traded neck-and-neck near the ~$4.7–4.9T top spot). Verify live before acting.*

Leadership read: **the "Bag7" is doing the damage.** Two names — **Alphabet (-7.1%) and Tesla (-14.5%) — accounted for ~30% of the S&P's weekly drawdown**, and Hedgeye has **NVDA, MSFT, AMZN, META and TSLA all on bearish TREND**. The lone bright spot was **Apple (+3.4% Friday)**, which reclaimed a share of the market-cap crown from Nvidia and is the year's Mag7 leader (~+22% YTD vs NVDA ~+7%). The trade is no longer "own the seven"; it's "own the one or two that still signal, short the rest."

7 · Positioning & Options

VIX spent the week climbing off the mid-teens, **spiking +12.4% Thursday to ~18.7** on the twin oil-and-tech shock before easing to ~**18.6** Friday. Breadth was ugly on the down days — decliners beat advancers ~**3-to-1 on the NYSE**. Credit leaned defensive with **HY and IG ETFs on bearish TREND**. Net read: **de-grossing, not capitulation**. With VIX on a bearish (higher) TREND and dispersion near decade highs, **optionality is cheap relative to realized single-stock moves** — favor defined-risk structures and hedges over naked beta.

8 · Sector Rotation — Leaders & Laggards

- **Leaders:** Industrials (XLI ~+1.8%), Utilities, Health Care — defensives and cyclicals with pricing power caught the rotation bid.
- **Laggards:** Communication Services (XLC ~-5.2%) and Consumer Discretionary (XLY ~-5.1%), dragged by Alphabet and Tesla respectively; Technology (XLK) stayed heavy.

Hedgeye read on the rotation: leadership is moving **out of mega-cap tech and into small-cap value + defensives** ("Quad3 Rotation Continues Beyond Mega-Cap Tech," MOMO Tracker, 22 Jul). With **RUT, XLV, XLU and XLRE on bullish TREND and XLK bearish**, the tape is rewarding domestic, rate-insensitive-earnings and real-asset exposure over long-duration growth.

9 · Corporate News — Key Earnings & Events

- **Alphabet (22 Jul):** Q2 beat — EPS $9.11, revenue $119.8bn — but 2026 capex guided up to $195–205bn; stock sold off, ~-7% on the week.

- **Tesla (22 Jul):** Adj. EPS $0.33 missed the $0.53 estimate; revenue +26% to $28.2bn; opex +~47% on AI/robotics; regulatory credits -67%. Shares -~14.5% Thursday to ~$308–320.
- **Semiconductors:** Violent round-trip — semis crashed ~15% into mid-July then ripped; SanDisk (Sandisk) fell ~11% Friday on the renewed chip wobble.
- **Positioning color:** Michael Burry disclosed added short exposure to Nvidia during the week, adding fuel to the AI-bubble debate.
- **Earnings season:** Broad S&P Q2 season underway and tracking a solid blended growth rate, but the market is punishing capex guidance and rewarding cash return.

10 · Macro Data — Key Releases

- **US initial jobless claims: 187k** (week ended 18 Jul), lowest since mid-May.

Net: Labor market still tight — removes the Fed's excuse to cut as oil re-heats inflation.

- **US housing:** Housing starts/permits (Fri) and existing-home sales (Thu) headlined an otherwise light calendar ahead of the FOMC.

Net: Rate-sensitive housing stays soft with the 10Y near 4.7% — a Quad3 drag on the consumer.

- **China:** H1 2026 GDP +4.7% y/y, but Q2 slowed to +4.3%, below the 4.5–5% target band; property still adjusting.

Net: Soft-but-not-collapsing China caps global growth and keeps commodity demand two-sided.

- **Europe / ECB:** ECB held the deposit rate at 2.25%; eurozone inflation cooled to 2.8% (core 2.4%), growth ~0.8%.

Net: ECB on hold in an "extremely volatile" energy backdrop — EUR/USD stays capped (bearish TREND).

- **Fed preview (28–29 Jul):** Consensus expects a 5th straight hold at 3.50–3.75%, but fixed-income markets price ~1-in-3 odds of a HIKE; Cook flagged inflation at 3.7%.

Net: A live meeting. Any hawkish surprise would validate the Quad3 short-duration trade.

11 · Geopolitics

The **2026 Iran war** dominated. The US completed its **12th consecutive night of strikes**; Iran-backed Houthis attacked two Saudi tankers (**Layla, Encelia**) and announced a Red Sea blockade, forcing at least seven vessels to reroute around the **Bab el-Mandeb** chokepoint. Trump threatened to hit Iranian infrastructure "every time" a ship is targeted in the Strait of Hormuz and said he was "**close to deciding**" on a larger strike.

Prediction markets stayed skeptical of full-scale invasion even as the risk premium rose: **Polymarket's "Will the U.S. invade Iran before 2027?" sat at ~30% "Yes"** on ~$46.7m of volume, reflecting a market that expects sustained strikes and blockade skirmishes rather than a ground war — consistent with the April ceasefire and the June 14 MoU framework that remain nominally in place.

> **Read:** The tail is an oil spike, not a ground invasion. Keep an **energy long / duration short** as the base case and own convex Hormuz hedges for the tail.

12 · Beyond the Markets — Also Worth Knowing

Summits, conferences & talks

- All eyes on the **28–29 July FOMC** — the week's true main event, with a genuinely uncertain outcome for the first time in months.
- World Bank published its July 2026 China Economic Update ("Rebalancing Growth"), trimming 2026 growth toward ~4.4%.

Science & frontier research

- Astronomers combined **Hubble + JWST** archives to find the first of the long-theorized "missing" intermediate-mass black holes.
- Shanghai Astronomical Observatory ran the first spatially resolved dual-frequency spectral study of the **M87 black hole** (EHT + GMVA data).
- A newly identified turning point in the Sun's 11-year cycle (21 Jul) may let scientists forecast solar activity years earlier.

Space & frontier tech

- China's **Tianwen-1** orbiter imaged interstellar comet **3I/ATLAS** as it raced past Mars on 24 Jul, capturing its tail and coma.

Weather & climate (market-moving)

- Red Sea/Hormuz shipping disruption — not weather but the week's key logistics shock — kept freight and energy-supply risk elevated; watch Atlantic hurricane season for a second energy catalyst into August.

Water cooler

- Markets, not scoreboards, provided the drama this week — Tesla's -14.5% single-day drop and semis' crash-then-rip round trip were the tape's headline highlights.

Appendix · Stock Cards

Compact cards for every name materially discussed above. Prices, caps and multiples are approximate end-of-week reference points — verify live before acting.

Tesla — TSLA

Price: ~$308–320 (-14.5% Thu, 23 Jul)
Valuation: Mkt cap ~$1.0T · P/E ~120x · no dividend · 52-wk wide range
Key dates: Q2 reported 22 Jul; next: Fed 28–29 Jul macro read-through
6-mo trend: Choppy-to-lower; down ~26% in July alone as deliveries/credits fade and capex balloons
Read: *Bearish TREND; the poster child for AI-capex-over-earnings. Avoid catching the knife until it re-signals.*

Alphabet — GOOGL

Price: ~$185 (-7.1% on the week)
Valuation: Mkt cap ~$4.3T · P/E ~22x · small dividend
Key dates: Q2 reported 22 Jul (EPS $9.11 beat, rev $119.8bn)
6-mo trend: Strong into July, then a sharp capex-driven reversal
Read: *Fundamentally fine, tactically sold on the $205bn capex print — the market's verdict on hyperscaler spend.*

Nvidia — NVDA

Price: ~$212 (-3.5% Fri)
Valuation: Mkt cap ~$4.7–4.8T · P/E ~48x · minimal dividend
Key dates: Next earnings late Aug; watch Fed 28–29 Jul
6-mo trend: +82% semis complex early July, -15% mid-month, then a rip — extreme two-way vol
Read: *Bearish immediate-term TREND and a fresh Burry short; the AI-bubble debate's epicenter.*

Apple — AAPL

Price: ~$315 (+3.4% Fri)
Valuation: Mkt cap ~$4.3–4.9T · P/E ~35x · ~0.4% dividend
Key dates: FQ3 earnings early Aug
6-mo trend: Best-in-Mag7, ~+22% YTD; reclaimed a share of the market-cap crown Friday
Read: *The one mega-cap still working — relative-strength leader as the rest of the complex rolls over.*

Microsoft — MSFT

Price: ~$495
Valuation: Mkt cap ~$3.7T · P/E ~36x · ~0.7% dividend
Key dates: FQ4 earnings late Jul/early Aug
6-mo trend: Uptrend stalling; flipped to bearish TREND on capex/AI-monetization doubts
Read: *Bearish TREND — another capex-heavy hyperscaler under the microscope.*

Amazon — AMZN

Price: ~$225
Valuation: Mkt cap ~$2.4T · P/E ~38x · no dividend
Key dates: Q2 earnings early Aug
6-mo trend: Range-bound to lower; momentum rolled over into bearish TREND
Read: *Bearish TREND; watch AWS capex commentary as the next AI-spend flashpoint.*

Meta — META

Price: ~$605
Valuation: Mkt cap ~$1.5T · P/E ~26x · small dividend
Key dates: Q2 earnings late Jul/early Aug
6-mo trend: Off the highs; TREND flipped bearish alongside the AI-capex cohort
Read: *Bearish TREND — cheapest of the hyperscalers but caught in the same capex de-rating.*

SanDisk — SNDK

Price: -11% Friday, 24 Jul

Valuation: Memory/storage cyclical; earnings-sensitive
Key dates: Part of the semis earnings/vol cluster
6-mo trend: High-beta round trip with the semis complex
Read: *Emblematic of semis' violent two-way tape; trade the range, respect the signal.*

Sources & Disclaimer

Sources: CNBC, Reuters, Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, The Washington Post/AP, The Motley Fool, Kitco, TradingEconomics, FXStreet/FX Leaders, FactSet, Forbes, Kiplinger, CGTN, World Bank, CNN, Euronews, Polymarket, ScienceDaily, and Hedgeye Risk Management (Early Look "The Way You Make Me Feel," MOMO Tracker, and Macro Week Summary Notes, 20–24 Jul 2026).

Figures are for the week ending Fri 24 July 2026 close unless noted; several mega-cap market caps, weekly percentage moves and multiples are approximate where a precise print could not be independently confirmed and are flagged as such. **Verify live prices before acting.** This document is informational, is not investment advice, and reflects third-party research (including Hedgeye) summarized for a private reader.